

COHORT 8.14 · FALL 2026 · WEEK 2

Two classes, one week, two opposite methods.

A working preparation deck for GEB 7911 Qualitative Research Methods and GEB 7365 International Business — the four philosophical assumptions, the interpretive frameworks, and the four papers on internationalization and performance.

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PRE-DISCUSSION · IN-CLASS · POST-DISCUSSION

WHO IS PRESENTING

Fifteen years auditing other people's judgment.

NOW

DBA candidate, FIU Chapman. Researching what happens to an auditor's judgment when an AI system reaches a conclusion first.

BEFORE

Citigroup and JPMorgan Chase — audit and risk, fifteen years.

BEFORE THAT

Bank examiner, Florida Office of Financial Regulation.

THE QUESTION

Not whether AI is accurate. Whether a professional who sees its answer first can still form an independent one.

WHY THIS WEEK MATTERS TO ME

My last study specified 55 items and could not be fielded. This week is where I find out whether that was a recruitment problem or a philosophical one.

THE WEEK AHEAD

Tuesday asks how to listen. Thursday asks how to measure.

TUE 25 AUG

7:00–9:30pm · Zoom

GEB 7911 — Qualitative Research Methods

Dr. Cristina Gonzalez

Week 2 · Assumptions, Frameworks, Study Design

THU 27 AUG

7:00–9:30pm · Zoom

GEB 7365 — International Business

Prof. William Newburry

Module 2 · Internationalization and Performance

THE THING WORTH NOTICING

These two courses want opposite methods from the same researcher in the same week. That is not a conflict to resolve. It is the clearest possible lesson in matching a method to a question.

PRE-DISCUSSION · TUESDAY

What Dr. Gonzalez is actually asking.

The Week 2 memo asks two questions of one qualitative article: name the four philosophical assumptions its researchers made, and identify the interpretive framework they worked inside. Neither is usually stated. You reason backwards from the design.

THE ARTICLE I CHOSE

Gioia, D. A., & Chittipeddi, K. (1991). Sensemaking and sensegiving in strategic change initiation. Strategic Management Journal, 12(6), 433–448.

Four questions every study answers, stated or not.

ONTOLOGICAL What is the nature of reality? <i>Multiple realities, or one?</i>	EPISTEMOLOGICAL What counts as knowledge, and how close does the researcher stand? <i>Proximity, or distance?</i>
AXIOLOGICAL What part do values play? <i>Declared, or controlled away?</i>	METHODOLOGICAL What procedures follow from the answers above? <i>Emergent, or fixed?</i>

THE POINT OF THE EXERCISE

You cannot opt out of these four. A study that never states them has still answered them — it has just let the instrument answer on its behalf. That is the difference between choosing a position and inheriting one.

They never state them. Here is what they did.

ONTOLOGICAL

Reality is multiple and participant-constructed. The change exists as the president's vision, the deans' reading of it, and the faculty's reading of the deans. Under a single-reality assumption that divergence would be error to minimise. Here it is the finding.

EPISTEMOLOGICAL

One author embedded on site as participant-observer; the other deliberately kept from direct contact. Closeness generates understanding and also threatens it — so the team is built to hold both positions at once.

AXIOLOGICAL

Values acknowledged rather than controlled away. The insider/outsider split is a reflexivity mechanism: instead of asserting neutrality, they install a colleague to interrogate the insider.

METHODOLOGICAL

Inductive and emergent. First-order informant terms up to second-order theoretical constructs, across two phases, adapting as understanding develops.

QUESTION FOR THE ROOM

If the insider/outsider split is doing both the epistemological and the axiological work, is it one design choice or two?

Three frameworks that matter to business research.

POST-POSITIVISM	SOCIAL CONSTRUCTIVISM	PRAGMATISM
DEDUCTIVE	INDUCTIVE	BOTH
• One reality, imperfectly apprehended • Researcher stands apart • Bias controlled and minimised • Theory tested against data • Rigour = procedure followed	• Multiple constructed realities • Researcher is close, and says so • Values declared, not removed • Theory built up from participants • Rigour = route shown to reader	• Reality is what works • Whatever distance the question needs • Values judged by consequences • Method chosen to fit the problem • Rigour = does it answer the question

WHAT THE TABLE CANNOT SHOW

These are drawn as three clean columns. Real articles do not sit in one column — which is the whole of my next slide, and the thing I most want to argue in class.

MY ARGUMENT FOR TUESDAY

Constructivist ontology, post-positivist discipline.



THE CLAIM

Gioia and Chittipeddi are social constructivist in what they take reality to be, and they run procedural discipline underneath it that is ordinarily post-positivist. The rigour is not a contradiction of the constructivism. It is what makes the constructivism credible rather than merely asserted.

WHY I CARE — AND THE QUESTION I WILL ASK

My own study committed to an ontology in which anchoring is a stable quantity you can ask "how much" about. I never argued for it — it arrived with the 55-item instrument. So: is a framework a label you select before fieldwork, or a position you can only describe afterwards?

Four papers. One diagnosis.

Module 2 — Internationalization and Performance. Presenting with Daniela Garcia Aguirre. These are usually read as four contributions to one literature. They are better read as the same failure happening four times.

THE SPINE

At each stage the field measured the wrong thing, or measured one thing while believing it had measured another.

That is not four topics. It is one diagnosis, four times.

What each one got wrong, and what it took to see it.

CONTRACTOR, KUNDU & HSU (2003)

JIBS 34(1)

The literature reported positive, negative, U and inverted-U findings for one relationship. All four were segments of a single sigmoid curve.

“Depending on which part of Figure 1 we examined, we can find linear, U-shaped, and inverted-U-shaped segments.”

MEZIAS (2002)

SMJ 23(3)

Liability of foreignness was accepted and never isolated, because performance measures aggregate everything. He abandons them for US labour lawsuit judgments — 486 foreign firms matched to 486 US firms.

“Labor lawsuits only measure labor-related disadvantage.”

GHEMAWAT (2001)

HBR 79(8)

Country portfolio analysis reads GDP and consumer wealth — it measures market size and is used as though it measured opportunity. Star TV: \$825m paid, ~\$500m lost.

“It ignores the costs and risks of doing business in a new market.”

ARREGLE ET AL. (2021)

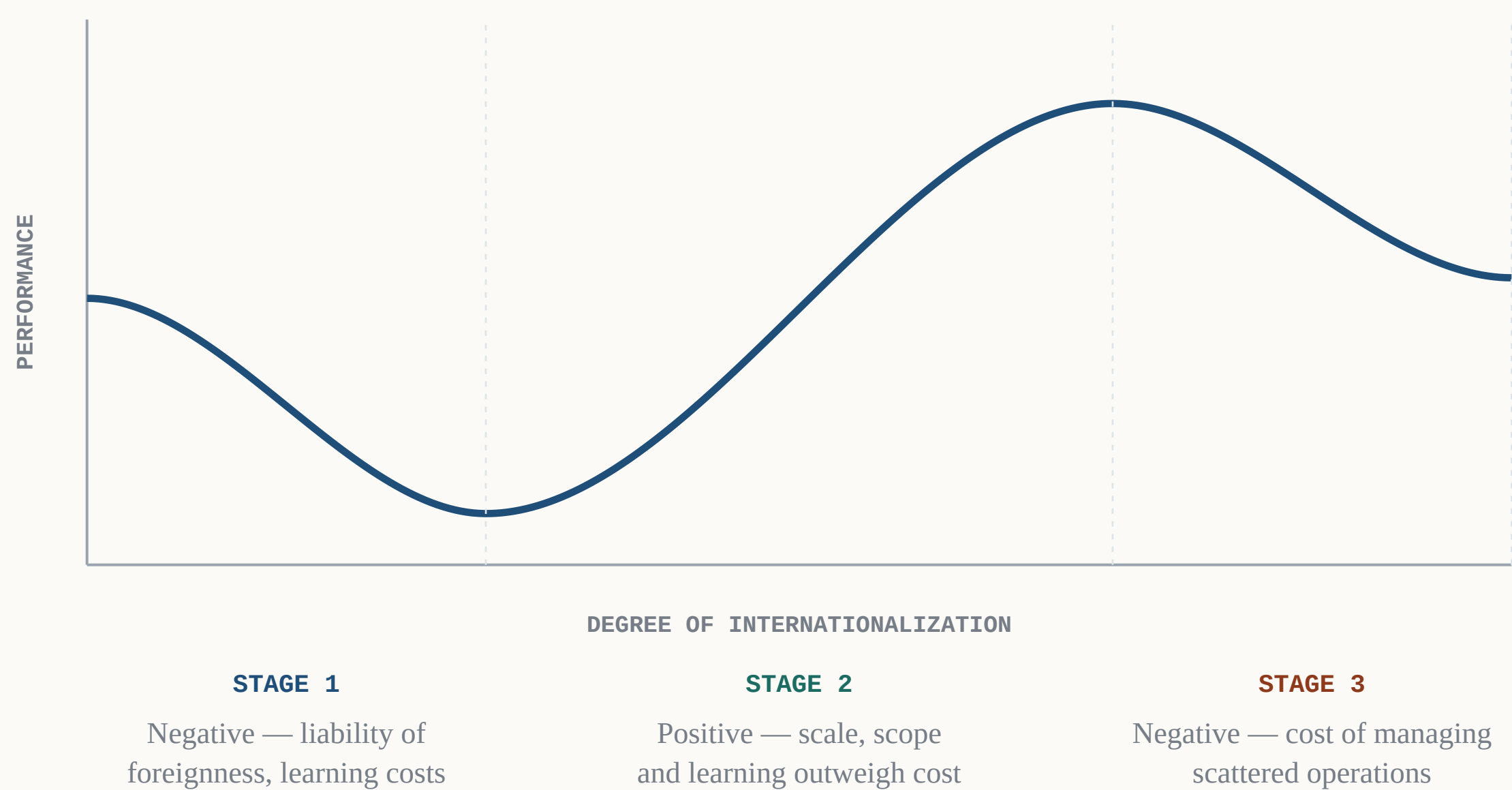
JIBS 52

220 studies across three decades of family firm internationalization. Theme 7 is Contractor's question, eighteen years later.

“Varied and at times incompatible findings.”

CONTRACTOR, KUNDU & HSU (2003), AFTER FIGURE 1

Why the field disagreed for thirty years.



THE MOVE THAT MAKES IT A CONTRIBUTION

Sample only the middle and you report a positive linear relationship. Sample the ends and you report an inverted U. The disagreement was partly artefactual.

Distance is four things. Star TV solved one.

C	CULTURAL Language, ethnicity, social norms, religion	
A	ADMINISTRATIVE Colonial ties, currency, trade blocs, political hostility	
G	GEOGRAPHIC Physical distance, borders, transport, climate	SOLVED <i>the only one</i>
E	ECONOMIC Consumer wealth, cost and quality of resources, infrastructure	

STAR TV · NEWS CORPORATION, 1993–95

Roughly \$825 million paid, on the reasoning that satellite delivery defeated geographic distance and English-language programming defeated the rest. Losses of approximately \$500 million followed across fiscal 1996–99.

Geographic distance was the only kind they had actually addressed.

The questions I want answered by Friday.

TUESDAY

Is an interpretive framework a label you choose before fieldwork, or a position you can only describe afterwards?

TUESDAY

If the insider/outsider design does both epistemological and axiological work, can reflexivity ever be a procedure rather than a stance?

THURSDAY

If contradictory findings are partly artefacts of where you sampled a curve, what does replication mean in this literature?

THURSDAY

Mezias made progress by abandoning aggregate measures. What is the equivalent move in audit judgment research?

BOTH

A literature that cannot converge because it cannot agree on a measure has a methods problem, not a theory problem. Does mine?

HOW I WILL LOG THE ANSWERS

Every one of these goes into the public course record with the date and the source. If it came from the room, it is attributed to the room. If it is still open on Friday, it stays marked open.

Everything here is working material, not a finished claim.

The readings are the professors'. The synthesis, the argument and any error in it are mine. Sources are cited on every slide that carries one, and anything still unresolved is marked as unresolved rather than smoothed over.

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THE FULL COURSE RECORD, OPEN

github.com/AuditingAI/Profile